QUINE AND STRAWSON

TWO LIMBS, TWO OWNERS → THE 1956 CLASH → OWNERSHIP LEDGER → THE FENCE → PROVENANCE → DOGMA ONE AND ITS THREE FAILED ROUTES → THE EXACT CONCLUSION → DOGMA TWO → CORPORATE BODY → ROOT IDENTITY → THE WEB → THREE OPTIONS → TWO SENTENCES → FOUR CONSEQUENCES → CONSTRAINTS → DUHEM-QUINE → NEPTUNE AND VULCAN → POPPER → REVISABILITY OF LOGIC → EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS → ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT → GAVAGAI → RELATIVITY AND NATURALISM → DESCRIPTIVE METAPHYSICS → BASIC PARTICULARS → AUDITORY WORLD → PERSONS → THE TWO RIVALS AND THE ANSWER SPINE

Read the continuous cyan rail from Stage 00 to the closing synthesis. Stages 00 to 13 carry Quine's printed critique of empiricism, 14 to 24 the positive doctrine and its limits, 25 to 27 the bounded Quinean enrichment, and 28 to 32 Strawson's printed theory of basic particulars and persons. Each card uses a layout chosen for its own content; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00 THE PRINTED CLAUSE AND ITS TWO NON-SHARED LIMBS

- CRITIQUE OF EMPIRICISM = QUINE
- BASIC PARTICULARS AND PERSONS = STRAWSON
- TWO PROMISES OF EMPIRICISM
- SORTING BY MEANING OR BY FACT
- REBUILDING THE WORLD FROM PRIVATE GIVENS
- ONE HEADING, TWO PROJECTS
- NO JOINT DOCTRINE EXISTS
- QUINE 1908-2000 | STRAWSON 1919-2006

THE CLAUSE, VERBATIM

- Syllabus item 11: 'Quine and Strawson : Critique of Empiricism; Theory of Basic Particulars and Persons.' The paper prints a space before the colon; preserve it only inside a verbatim quotation.
- Limb one is Quine's printed burden: two dogmas, the failed explications of analyticity, reductionism, confirmation holism, revisability and empiricism without the dogmas.
- Limb two is Strawson's: descriptive metaphysics, identification and re-identification, the public spatio-temporal framework, material bodies and the person as a primitive concept.

THE TWO PROMISES BEING BROKEN

- Promise one: every meaningful sentence can be sorted into true-by-meaning and true-by-fact, and checked against experience one at a time. Quine breaks this from inside empiricism.
- Promise two: the world can be rebuilt out of private sensory givens. Strawson shows it cannot even get started, because identification requires a public framework.

THE FATAL OPENING

- 'The Quine-Strawson critique of empiricism holds that ...' attributes a joint doctrine that does not exist and that the record contradicts.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the two limbs are owned separately, the first decision in the hall is which thinker the stem names, and that decision changes the whole answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The syllabus pairs two critics of empiricism who criticise it at different levels: Quine reforms its theory of confirmation from inside, while Strawson shows that its private sense-datum starting point cannot support identification at all.

STAGE 01 THE TWO-PROJECT WARNING AND THE DOCUMENTED CLASH OF 1956

- IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA 1956
- CO-AUTHORED WITH H. P. GRICE
- BRITISH SPELLING: DEFENCE
- THEY ARE NOT ALLIES
- STANDARDS OF EXPLICATION
- PROBLEM-FIELD, NOT A THESIS

WHAT GRICE AND STRAWSON ARGUE

- The analytic/synthetic distinction is ordinarily intelligible: competent speakers agree on cases without any theory.
- A distinction in good working order is not discredited merely because no reductive analysis of it is available; Quine demands a non-circular definition where what we have is a usable distinction.

QUINE'S REJOINDER

- Ordinary intelligibility is not theoretical legitimacy. Agreement in classification does not supply the principled ground on which the positivist meaning-criterion and the linguistic theory of necessity were resting.

THE ONLY LEGITIMATE JOINT SENTENCE

- Empiricism failed twice over: about how theories are confirmed (Quine) and about how we so much as refer (Strawson). That is a problem-field, not a shared thesis.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the only documented exchange between the two printed thinkers is a disagreement, no answer may present them as co-authors of one anti-empiricist doctrine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine and Strawson share a target and not a doctrine, and the 1956 paper in which Grice and Strawson defend the very distinction Quine attacked is the documentary proof.

STAGE 02 OWNERSHIP LEDGER: NINE PYQ PARTS BETWEEN 2018 AND 2025

- 9 OF 112 PARTS
- QUINE FIVE PARTS
- STRAWSON FOUR PARTS
- NONE IN 2022
- TWO EACH IN 2018 AND 2021
- THE ONLY 20-MARKER IS 2023

QUINE'S FIVE ROUTED PARTS

- 2018 Q2(c), 15 marks: how Quine shows that the Kantian a priori is 'a metaphysical article of faith'.
- 2019 Q1(e), 10 marks: Quine's arguments against the synthetic-analytic distinction. 2021 Q3(c), 15 marks: empiricism without the dogmas.
- 2024 Q4(c), 15 marks: the nature of the two dogmas. 2025 Q4(b), 15 marks: the statement about affirming the truth of any sentence.

STRAWSON'S FOUR ROUTED PARTS

- 2018 Q1(e), 10 marks: how Strawson explains the concept of person. 2020 Q3(b), 15 marks: spatio-temporal thinking in objective thinking.
- 2021 Q3(b), 15 marks: material bodies and persons as basic particulars. 2023 Q4(a), 20 marks: person as primitive and the implication for mind-body dualism.

WHAT THE DISTRIBUTION MEANS

- The clause is frequent but not guaranteed, so it must be prepared to answer rather than to recognise; and the Strawson parts escalate from a 10-marker in 2018 to the clause's only 20-marker in 2023.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because five parts are Quine's and four are Strawson's, and none asks for a joint doctrine, the stem alone fixes which spine is run.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: This clause owns nine of one hundred and twelve Western Philosophy parts, split five to Quine and four to Strawson, with two each in 2018 and 2021 and none at all in 2022.

STAGE 03 THE OWNERSHIP FENCE AROUND FIVE NEIGHBOURING CLAUSES

- TOPIC 07 OWNS VERIFICATIONISM
- TOPIC 03 OWNS HUME
- TOPIC 04 OWNS KANT
- TOPIC 06 OWNS DESCRIPTIONS
- TOPIC 08 OWNS LANGUAGE-GAMES
- FREEDOM AND RESENTMENT IS NOT PYQ-OWNED
- BOUNDED QUINE ENRICHMENT

NOT OWNED HERE, AS DOCTRINE

- The verification principle, Ayer, Carnap's Aufbau and the Vienna Circle belong to Topic 07 and appear here only as the position Quine dismantles.
- Hume's impressions and ideas, the bundle self and induction belong to Topic 03; Kant's synthetic a priori and transcendental deduction to Topic 04; Russell's theory of descriptions to Topic 06; meaning as use and the private-language argument to Topic 08.
- Strawson's 'Freedom and Resentment' (1962), his treatment of induction (1952) and his Kant interpretation (1966) are bounded or cross-owned; personal identity over time, the soul and immortality belong to Paper II.

BOUNDED BUT FULLY TAUGHT

- Ontological commitment, radical translation and gavagai, inscrutability, indeterminacy, ontological relativity and naturalized epistemology are system-enrichment: available in full, but not independently printed or PYQ-owned in 2018-2025.
- They are deployed only after the two-dogmas and holism burden has been discharged, and never in place of it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because a third of a Quine answer spent on the Vienna Circle answers a Topic 07 question that was not asked, the fence has to be drawn before the first paragraph.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The critique of empiricism is Quine's printed burden and basic particulars and persons are Strawson's, so neighbouring clauses supply contrast only and never content.

STAGE 04 PROVENANCE RAIL, PART ONE: 1905 TO 1953

- DUHEM 1906
- CARNAP AUFBAU 1928
- BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN 1936
- ON WHAT THERE IS 1948
- ON REFERRING 1950
- TWO DOGMAS JANUARY 1951
- REVISED 1953
- NOT FROM TWO DOGMAS

THE DATED LEDGER

- 1905 Russell 'On Denoting'. 1906 Duhem, La Theorie physique, English translation by Wiener 1954: physics only, logic and mathematics exempt. 1928 Carnap's Aufbau. 1934 Popper, Logik der Forschung, English 1959.
- 1936 Birkhoff and von Neumann, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics', Annals of Mathematics: the formal non-distributive lattice, and not yet the claim that logic is empirical.
- 1948 Quine 'On What There Is', Review of Metaphysics: the criterion of ontological commitment. 1950 Strawson 'On Referring', Mind. 1951 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism', The Philosophical Review, January; revised in From a Logical Point of View, 1953.

THE TWO DATING TRAPS

- 'To be is to be the value of a bound variable' summarises the 1948 criterion and is never sourced to 'Two Dogmas'.
- 'On Referring' predates Individuals by nine years, so it is a precursor rather than an application of descriptive metaphysics.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because this clause tests dating and attribution as directly as doctrine, the rail is learned as a list and cited by section wherever possible.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The web-of-belief passage is section six of 'Two Dogmas', 'Empiricism without the Dogmas', and citing the section rather than the paper is the cheapest mark on the clause.

STAGE 05 PROVENANCE RAIL, PART TWO: 1956 TO 1985

- IN DEFENCE OF A DOGMA 1956
- INDIVIDUALS 1959
- WORD AND OBJECT 1960
- PUTNAM 1968
- DEWEY LECTURES 1968, VOLUME 1969
- PHILOSOPHY OF LOGIC 1970
- DAVIDSON 1973 INTERPRETATION
- NEVER DATE NATURALISM TO 1951

THE DATED LEDGER

- 1952 Introduction to Logical Theory, induction in ch. 9. 1956 Grice and Strawson, 'In Defence of a Dogma'. 1959 Individuals: An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics, basic particulars Part I and persons ch. 3, the phrase in the subtitle.
- 1960 Word and Object, radical translation and gavagai in ch. 2, epigraph Neurath's boat. 1962 'Freedom and Resentment'. 1966 The Bounds of Sense, with the 'non-sequitur of numbing grossness' charge.
- 1968 Putnam 'Is Logic Empirical?'; 1968 Dewey Lectures published 1969 with 'Epistemology Naturalized'; 1969 Chomsky 'Quine's Empirical Assumptions'; 1970 Philosophy of Logic; 1973 Davidson 'Radical Interpretation'; 1985 Skepticism and Naturalism.

THE ATTRIBUTION TRAPS

- 'In Defence of a Dogma' is co-authored with Grice, and attributing it to Strawson alone is a standard slip.
- Davidson wrote on radical interpretation, not radical translation: the change of word marks the change of doctrine, since charity and a truth-theory replace a shared observation base.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the same volume of 1969 carries both ontological relativity and naturalized epistemology, dating either doctrine to 1951 compresses eighteen years of development.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Naturalized epistemology belongs to the Dewey Lectures of 1968 published in 1969, and the governing image, Neurath's boat, is the epigraph of Word and Object of 1960.

STAGE 06 DOGMA ONE: THE CLAIM UNDER TEST AND ITS TWO CLASSES

- ANALYTIC = TRUE BY MEANING
- SYNTHETIC = TRUE BY FACT
- CLASS 1 LOGICAL TRUTHS
- CLASS 2 SYNONYM SUBSTITUTION
- SYNONYMY IS THE LOAD-BEARING NOTION
- START HERE, NOT AT CIRCULARITY

THE DOGMA, STATED

- There is a principled, non-arbitrary line between statements true by virtue of meaning alone and statements true by virtue of extra-linguistic fact.
- It is a dogma because the line cannot be drawn non-circularly by any explication its defenders offered.

THE TWO CLASSES

- Class one is logically true: 'No unmarried man is married' is true under every reinterpretation of its non-logical words, and Quine grants this class.
- Class two becomes a class-one truth once synonyms are substituted: 'No bachelor is married' turns on putting 'unmarried man' for 'bachelor'. This class needs synonymy.

THE QUESTION THAT DRIVES THE PAPER

- What is synonymy? Three routes are available, and each returns to the platform it left.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because only the second class needs synonymy, an answer that opens at 'the notion is circular' has skipped the step that shows why synonymy was required.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine begins by dividing analytic truths into logical truths and truths reducible to them by substituting synonyms, because it is the second class that forces the search for a criterion of sameness of meaning.

STAGE 07 ROUTE ONE FAILS: A DEFINITION MERELY RECORDS A SYNONYMY

- DEFINITION
- RECORDS AN ANTECEDENT SYNONYMY
- EXPLANATORY ORDER, NOT FORM
- STIPULATION IS THE EXCEPTION
- CIRCULAR

THE PROPOSAL AND ITS COLLAPSE

- Proposal: two terms are synonymous when one is defined as the other, as the lexicographer defines bachelor as unmarried man.
- Failure: except for frankly stipulative definitions, a definition reports a synonymy that already obtained; the lexicographer is an empirical scientist recording usage.

THE PRECISION THAT EARNS THE MARK

- The circularity lies in the explanatory order, not in the sentence: definitions are not circular in form. Writing 'definitions are circular' mistakes the objection.
- Quine concedes that stipulative definition creates synonymy by fiat in a new notation, but that cannot ground the general notion for a language already in use.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because a definition presupposes the relation it was summoned to explain, the first route ends where it began rather than failing for want of evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The appeal to definition fails because, outside frank stipulation, a definition records a sameness of meaning that the language already contained.

STAGE 08 ROUTE TWO FAILS TWICE: INTERCHANGEABILITY SALVA VERITATE

- SALVA VERITATE
- CREATURE WITH A HEART
- CREATURE WITH A KIDNEY
- EXTENSIONAL OVER-GENERATION
- NECESSITY OPERATOR REPAIR
- REPAIR PRESUPPOSES THE TARGET

FAILURE (A): THE WEAK TEST ADMITS TOO MUCH

- In a purely extensional language, coextensive but non-synonymous terms interchange freely. 'Creature with a heart' and 'creature with a kidney' pass the test and are not synonymous.

FAILURE (B): THE STRONG TEST ASSUMES THE ANSWER

- Repairing the test by demanding interchange inside 'necessarily' requires a language already containing a necessity operator whose intelligibility, for Quine, rests on analyticity.
- Weak test lets in too much; strong test assumes the answer. There is no setting of the dial that works.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because strengthening the criterion imports the notion under examination, the second route fails not by accident but by the structure of the repair.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Interchangeability preserving truth over-generates in an extensional language and can be repaired only by a necessity operator that presupposes the analyticity being defined.

STAGE 09 ROUTE THREE FAILS: CARNAP'S SEMANTICAL RULES GIVE A LIST

- SEMANTICAL RULES
- ANALYTIC-IN-L
- A LIST, NOT AN EXPLANATION
- RELATIVISING MOVES THE PROBLEM
- GENERAL NOTION UNTOUCHED

WHAT THE DEVICE DELIVERS

- Analyticity is defined for an artificial language L by explicit semantical rules, and a sentence is analytic-in-L if the rules say so.
- We therefore learn the membership of a set; we do not learn what membership consists in.

WHY THAT IS NOT ENOUGH

- The general explanatory notion 'semantical rule' is no clearer than 'analytic', so the question 'what makes these the semantical rules?' is the original question in new clothing.
- Treating 'analytic-in-L' as a successful definition of 'analytic' concedes the very generality Quine denies.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because relativising analyticity to a stipulated language moves the problem without solving it, the third route leaves the general notion exactly where it was.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Carnap's semantical rules can classify sentences inside a constructed language, but they cannot explain what being so classified amounts to.

STAGE 10 THE EXACT CONCLUSION, AND THE CENTRALITY CAUTION

- EXPLICATIONS FAIL
- NOT: ANALYTIC SENTENCES ARE FALSE
- NOT: THE WORD HAS NO USE
- DEGREES OF ENTRENCHMENT
- ENTRENCHMENT IS NOT A DEFINITION
- DIFFERENCE OF DEGREE

WHAT QUINE CONCLUDES

- The available explications fail to provide the clear, non-question-begging boundary that logical empiricism required.
- Holistic revisability replaces categorical immunity with degrees of practical entrenchment: central statements are revised rarely and peripheral ones easily.

WHAT QUINE DOES NOT CONCLUDE

- Not that 'All bachelors are unmarried' is false; not that the word 'analytic' has no use in any language; and not that one missing dictionary entry proves unintelligibility.
- Practical entrenchment explains why logic and mathematics are normally protected, but it is not a replacement definition of 'analytic'. Presenting it as one converts a strength into an error.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the target is the foundational employment of the distinction rather than ordinary classification, the conclusion must be stated in its narrow form to survive the standard reply.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not show that familiar classifications are unintelligible; he argues that the available explications cannot ground the sharp foundational boundary empiricism required.

STAGE 11 DOGMA TWO: REDUCTIONISM IN ITS RADICAL AND ATTENUATED FORMS

- REDUCTIONISM
- RADICAL: TERM-BY-TERM TRANSLATION
- ATTENUATED: INDIVIDUAL CONFIRMATION
- CARNAP'S AUFBAU AS EXEMPLAR
- THE LABEL NAMES THE OPERATION
- ONE OBJECTION DEFEATS BOTH

THE TWO FORMS

- Radical form: every meaningful statement is translatable into a language of immediate experience, term by term, as in Carnap's Aufbau of 1928.
- Attenuated form: translation is abandoned, but each statement taken alone is held to have its own range of confirming and disconfirming experiences.

WHY THE LABEL FITS

- The doctrine reduces the meaning of each sentence to a set of observation sentences. Explaining the label is a cheap mark that most scripts leave on the table.

THE SHARED ASSUMPTION

- Both forms assume a sentence-sized parcel of evidence, so removing that assumption collapses them together.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because both forms depend on a sentence-sized unit of confirmation, a single objection about the unit disposes of the radical and the attenuated version at once.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Reductionism is the assumption that each meaningful statement has its own private stock of confirming experiences, and the name records the operation of reducing sentence-meaning to observation sentences.

STAGE 12 THE CORPORATE BODY AND THE UNIT OF EMPIRICAL SIGNIFICANCE

- FACE THE TRIBUNAL AS A CORPORATE BODY
- NOT THE TERM
- NOT THE SENTENCE
- THE WHOLE OF SCIENCE
- EXPERIENCE IS RETAINED
- ONLY ATOMISM IS DENIED

THE CANONICAL SENTENCE

- 'Our statements about the external world face the tribunal of sense experience not individually but only as a corporate body.' Quote it exactly; it is the pivot of the paper.

THE UNIT

- Not the term, since that programme had already collapsed; not the sentence, since that is the dogma being removed; but the whole of science.

WHAT IS NOT DENIED

- Quine denies that experience bears on beliefs one at a time, not that it bears on belief at all. That is exactly why the resulting position is still called empiricism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the tribunal still sits and hears the system, holism corrects the address of evidence rather than abolishing evidential control.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The unit of empirical significance is the whole of science, so no statement possesses a private stock of confirming experiences of its own.

STAGE 13 WHY THE TWO DOGMAS ARE AT ROOT IDENTICAL

- AT ROOT IDENTICAL
- CONFIRMED COME WHAT MAY
- NEEDS A CONTRAST CLASS
- DOGMA TWO SUPPLIES IT
- LIST BECOMES ARGUMENT

THE ARGUMENT IN FOUR STEPS

- Dogma one survives only if some statements are confirmed independently of experience, that is, held true come what may.
- That contrast requires a contrast class: statements confirmed individually by their own experiences. Dogma two supplies exactly that picture.
- Remove dogma two and dogma one has nothing left to be a contrast to.

WHY IT EARNS MARKS

- It converts a list of two criticisms into an argument with a structure, and it is the natural closing line of a 2024 Q4(c) answer.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the first dogma is definable only against the second, the paper's two halves form a single argument rather than two separate complaints.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine's own architectural judgement is that the two dogmas are at root identical, since the class of statements held true come what may exists only by contrast with individually confirmed ones.

STAGE 14 THE WEB OF BELIEF: FIELD OF FORCE AND BOUNDARY CONDITIONS

- FIELD OF FORCE
- BOUNDARY CONDITIONS = EXPERIENCE
- PERIPHERY: OBSERVATION SENTENCES
- INTERIOR: PHYSICS, MATHS, LOGIC
- SECTION 6 OF TWO DOGMAS
- PERIPHERY IS NOT SENSE-DATA

THE STRUCTURE

- Observation sentences lie at the periphery, in direct contact with experience; physics, chemistry and biology are revised comparatively easily; mathematics rarely; logic last, and never immune.
- Only the edge touches experience. The interior is connected to it by inferential threads, so a collision at the edge produces re-adjustment inside.

THE CAUTION THAT SAVES THE ANSWER

- The periphery consists of observation sentences and not of private sense-data. Quine is rejecting the sense-datum programme here rather than restating it.

WHERE THE PASSAGE SITS

- The web and field-of-force passage is section 6, 'Empiricism without the Dogmas'. Citing the section is checkable and cheap.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because only the boundary of the field is in contact with experience, a recalcitrant observation forces adjustment somewhere inside without naming the place.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Total science is a field of force whose boundary conditions are experience, so conflict at the edge requires revision inside and the location of that revision is chosen rather than dictated.

STAGE 15 THE THREE REVISION OPTIONS, AND WHY THE THIRD MATTERS

- REVISE THE PERIPHERY
- REVISE THE INTERIOR
- PLEAD HALLUCINATION
- EXPERIENCE NEVER NAMES A SENTENCE
- OMITTING OPTION THREE WEAKENS THE ANSWER

THE THREE OPTIONS

- Option one: revise a nearby peripheral belief, which is easiest. Option two: revise a deep interior statement, which is costly but open in principle.
- Option three: plead hallucination and revise the observation statement itself, which is always available.

WHY THE THIRD IS DECISIVE

- It is what makes 'any statement can be held true come what may' literally true rather than rhetorical. Omit it and the famous sentence looks like an exaggeration.

THE GAP THAT IS THE DOCTRINE

- Experience says that something here is wrong. Experience never says that this sentence is wrong. The gap between those two sentences is the whole doctrine.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the observation report is itself revisable, no experience can compel the surrender of any particular statement in the system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Conflict at the edge leaves three open responses, and the availability of the third is what makes the famous sentence a theorem rather than a flourish.

STAGE 16 THE TWO CANONICAL SENTENCES AND THEIR QUALIFIERS

- HELD TRUE COME WHAT MAY
- IF DRASTIC ADJUSTMENTS ELSEWHERE
- NO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE
- EVEN A LAW OF LOGIC, IN PRINCIPLE
- TRUNCATION PRODUCES RELATIVISM
- 2025 Q4(B) TURNS ON THIS

SENTENCE ONE

- 'Any statement can be held true come what may, if we make drastic enough adjustments elsewhere in the system.' The conditional clause is the doctrine, because it names the cost.
- The 2025 paper prints it as: 'We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere.'

SENTENCE TWO

- 'Conversely, by the same token, no statement is immune to revision.' The early essay extends this in principle even to a law of logic, mentioning the proposed revision of excluded middle to simplify quantum mechanics.
- It does not follow that every revision is equally rational, or that logic is casually abandoned.

THE TRAP

- Quoting the first half and calling it relativism is the commonest way of failing 2025 Q4(b).

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the cost clause disciplines the affirmation, the sentence describes holistic confirmation rather than licence to believe anything.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The conditional clause carries the doctrine: any statement can be held true come what may only at the price of drastic adjustments elsewhere in the system.

STAGE 17 THE FOUR CONSEQUENCES OF CONFIRMATION HOLISM

- NO SHARP ANALYTIC/SYNTHETIC LINE
- NO SHARP A PRIORI LINE
- PRAGMATIC THEORY-CHOICE
- SIMPLICITY, CONSERVATISM, FECUNDITY
- MEANING-CRITERION LOSES APPLICATION
- HOLISTIC VERIFICATIONISM IS A FURTHER QUESTION

THE FIRST THREE

- One: no sharp analytic/synthetic line, since central logic and mathematics are entrenched rather than immune.
- Two: no sharp a priori/a posteriori line, since all beliefs are revisable in the light of experience even when remote from the periphery.
- Three: theory-choice is pragmatic, decided by simplicity, conservatism and fecundity rather than by algorithmic rules.

THE FOURTH, STATED CAREFULLY

- Sentence-by-sentence reductionist verification is undermined. Whether a holistic verificationism survives is a further question that the paper does not settle.
- Saying 'holism refutes verificationism' overstates the result and invites correction.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the fourth consequence is narrower than it looks, an answer that states it precisely gains exactly where an overclaiming answer loses.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Holism removes both sharp boundaries and makes theory-choice pragmatic, while undermining sentence-by-sentence verification without by itself refuting every holistic verificationism.

STAGE 18 WHAT BLOCKS ARBITRARY REVISION

- PREDICTIVE SUCCESS
- CONSERVATISM
- SIMPLICITY
- FECUNDITY
- MINIMUM MUTILATION 1970
- REVISABLE BY CHOICE, NOT BY NATURE

THE OBJECTION

- If everything is revisable, science has no fixed point and rational belief has no constraint; is holism even coherent?

THE CONSTRAINTS

- Revisions must keep the system predicting; conservatism prefers minimal change; simplicity prefers the economical system; fecundity prefers the system that generates results.
- The maxim of minimum mutilation is added in Philosophy of Logic of 1970.

WHAT IS AND IS NOT LICENSED

- Holism licenses the re-allocation of blame across the system. It does not license indifference to evidence or the claim that all revisions are equally warranted.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because no statement is revisable by nature but only by choice, and choice carries costs, the charge of arbitrariness is answered without abandoning revisability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The location of revision is disciplined by predictive success, conservatism, simplicity, fecundity and the later maxim of minimum mutilation.

STAGE 19 THE DUHEM-QUINE ARGUMENT IN SIX NUMBERED STEPS

- (H AND A) IMPLIES O
- OBSERVE NOT-O
- MODUS TOLLENS
- NOT (H AND A) ONLY
- LOGIC NAMES NO CONJUNCT
- DOGMA TWO LOSES APPLICATION

THE DERIVATION

- The testable claim is (H and A) implies O, where A gathers background theory, instrument theory and initial conditions. Observation reports not-O.
- Modus tollens yields only not-(H and A): H is false or some element of A is false. Logic does not say which, though evidence and method can still make some revisions far more reasonable.
- Therefore refutation is never conclusive against a single statement, and a reductionist criterion assigning each statement its own confirming experiences has no application.

THE PRESUPPOSITIONS WHERE OBJECTIONS ENTER

- Hypotheses generate predictions only with auxiliaries; no fixed decomposition uniquely assigns a recalcitrant experience to one sentence; theory-choice employs pragmatic virtues alongside evidence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the negation of a conjunction leaves the distribution of blame open, the choice of what to revise is a methodological act rather than a logical consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Modus tollens condemns only the conjunction of hypothesis and auxiliaries, so the choice of what to surrender is never dictated by the evidence alone.

STAGE 20 DUHEM AGAINST QUINE: SCOPE, EXEMPTIONS, COROLLARY, MOTIVE

- DUHEM 1906: PHYSICS ONLY
- QUINE 1951: ALL KNOWLEDGE
- LOGIC AND MATHS EXEMPT
- NOTHING EXEMPT
- NO EXPERIMENTUM CRUCIS
- TWO NON-IDENTICAL CLAIMS

SCOPE AND EXEMPTIONS

- Duhem restricts the thesis to theoretical physics and holds that physiology and certain other sciences can test hypotheses more nearly in isolation; he exempts logic and mathematics.
- Quine extends it to all of knowledge, because the unit of empirical significance is the whole of science, and exempts nothing: no statement is immune to revision.

COROLLARY AND MOTIVE

- Duhem's chief corollary is that there is no automatic experimentum crucis against an isolated hypothesis, since auxiliaries are also in play; his motive is the philosophy and practice of physics.
- Quine's corollary is confirmation holism with underdetermination pressure; his motive is the demolition of the second dogma. The stronger claim about total theories requires further argument.

THE LABEL

- 'Duhem-Quine thesis' is later shorthand for two non-identical claims, and saying so is itself a mark.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the extension from physics to all knowledge is Quine's own and controversial step, it is exactly what makes the analytic/synthetic collapse follow.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Duhem confined the thesis to physics and exempted logic and mathematics, so the shared label covers two claims that differ in scope and in what they place at risk.

STAGE 21 NEPTUNE AND VULCAN: THE PAIR THAT PROVES THE POINT

- URANUS ANOMALY
- NEPTUNE FOUND 1846
- MERCURY PERIHELION
- VULCAN DOES NOT EXIST
- GENERAL RELATIVITY 1915
- NO RULE IN ADVANCE

CASE ONE: THE SHALLOW REVISION WAS RIGHT

- The orbit of Uranus conflicted with Newtonian prediction; astronomers did not abandon Newton's laws but revised the auxiliary assumption that all planets were known, and Neptune was found by Le Verrier and Adams in 1846.

CASE TWO: THE DEEP REVISION WAS RIGHT

- The perihelion of Mercury produced the same move and the hypothesised planet Vulcan, which does not exist; the correct revision proved to be general relativity in 1915.

WHY BOTH MUST BE DEPLOYED

- Same logical situation, opposite correct responses, and no rule saying in advance which to choose. Citing Neptune alone makes holism look like a recipe for saving theories.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because two identical logical situations demanded opposite revisions, the thesis is demonstrated historically rather than merely asserted.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Uranus and Mercury anomalies show the same strategy being right once and wrong once, which is precisely the claim that no rule fixes the choice of revision in advance.

STAGE 22 POPPER AND LAKATOS: THE REPLY THAT CONCEDES THE LOGIC

- POPPER ACCEPTS THE LOGIC
- FALSIFICATION AS A DECISION
- BASIC STATEMENTS BY CONVENTION
- NO AD HOC RESCUES
- LAKATOS: HARD CORE
- LAKATOS: PROTECTIVE BELT

POPPER'S POSITION

- Popper accepts the logical point entirely and denies its sceptical use. Falsification is a methodological decision: scientists agree by convention to treat certain basic statements as unproblematic for a test.
- Ad hoc rescues that reduce a theory's testability are forbidden, so rationality is preserved by rules of method rather than by logic alone.

LAKATOS'S DEVELOPMENT

- Research programmes with a protected hard core and a revisable protective belt turn Duhem-Quine into a criterion of progress.

THE TRAP

- 'Popper refutes Duhem-Quine' is a factual error an examiner can check. He grants the logic and answers it with method.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the reply operates at the level of method rather than logic, it shows that holism constrains scientific rationality without dissolving it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Popper concedes that logic never names the guilty conjunct and answers the sceptical use by convention and by a prohibition on testability-reducing rescues.

STAGE 23 THE REVISABILITY OF LOGIC: 1936, 1968 AND THE RETREAT OF 1970

- BIRKHOFF AND VON NEUMANN 1936
- NON-DISTRIBUTIVE LATTICE
- PUTNAM 1968
- DISTRIBUTIVE LAW
- PUTNAM LATER ABANDONED IT
- CHANGE OF LOGIC, CHANGE OF SUBJECT
- MINIMUM MUTILATION
- NEVER WRITE PUTNAM/BIRKHOFF

TWO ACTS, THIRTY-TWO YEARS APART

- 1936: Birkhoff and von Neumann, 'The Logic of Quantum Mechanics', Annals of Mathematics, propose a non-distributive lattice of propositions. This is a mathematical proposal.
- 1968: Putnam, 'Is Logic Empirical?', argues that logic is empirical and that the distributive law should be revised on empirical grounds. This is a philosophical claim about the first, reprinted 1976, and Putnam later abandoned it.

THE RESISTANCE, FROM QUINE HIMSELF

- Philosophy of Logic of 1970 argues that anyone who denies a law of logic has merely changed the meaning of the connectives, so no genuine disagreement occurs, and invokes the maxim of minimum mutilation.

THE HONEST VERDICT

- Holism is right about confirmation and overstated about revisability; the defensible position is Duhem's thesis with Quine's motivation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the strongest textual support for revising logic comes from Putnam and not from Quine, the later Quine is a poor witness for the earlier Quine's boldest claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Logic is revisable in principle and protected in practice by entrenchment and by the cost of mutilation, not by any certificate of analyticity.

STAGE 24 EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS, AND THE 2018 FRAMING

- SUBTRACTION, NOT REPLACEMENT
- SENSORY EVIDENCE KEPT
- NATURALISM KEPT
- NO FIRST PHILOSOPHY
- METAPHYSICS DIFFERS IN DEGREE
- ARTICLE OF FAITH IS THE PAPER'S WORDING
- NEVER: QUINE REJECTED EMPIRICISM

WHAT SURVIVES AND WHAT GOES

- Kept: sensory evidence as the check on the system, scientific naturalism, and the refusal of any first philosophy outside science.
- Dropped: sentence-by-sentence reduction and the foundational analytic/synthetic boundary. The line between speculative metaphysics and natural science becomes a matter of degree.

THE 2018 QUESTION, HANDLED CORRECTLY

- 'A metaphysical article of faith' is the question's framing, not a verified verbatim Quine quotation, and must not be placed in quotation marks as his own formula.
- What Quine supplies is three moves: the explication of analyticity fails; holism makes nothing a priori by nature; and naturalism denies any standpoint from which the a priori could be certified.

THE KANTIAN REPLY AND THE REJOINDER

- Kant may answer that transcendental conditions are not empirical hypotheses inside the web; Quine's rejoinder is that this reasserts the privileged status in question.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the word 'without' does all the work in the section title, the position is a reform of empiricism and never its abandonment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine is not an opponent of empiricism but its most damaging internal critic, removing the two assumptions that made it foundationalist and keeping everything that made it empiricist.

STAGE 25 ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT AND THE BOUND VARIABLE

- ON WHAT THERE IS 1948
- REGIMENT INTO QUANTIFICATIONAL FORM
- RANGE OF THE BOUND VARIABLES
- AUDIT, NOT ALGORITHM
- PARAPHRASE, NOT WORD-COUNTING
- PARSIMONY, NOT NOMINALISM
- QUINE AND PUTNAM ON INDISPENSABILITY

THE CRITERION

- Regiment the accepted theory into perspicuous quantificational form, then read off the entities that must lie in the ranges of its bound variables for the theory to be true. Those are its commitments.
- 'To be is to be the value of a bound variable' is the standard slogan for the criterion developed in 'On What There Is' of 1948, and is never sourced to 'Two Dogmas'.

FOUR CAUTIONS

- It is a criterion of commitment and not a rule for choosing an ontology; commitment is not surface word-counting, since names can be paraphrased away while name-free quantification can carry commitment.
- The taste for desert landscapes expresses parsimony rather than nominalism at any cost, and the indispensability argument is associated with Quine and Putnam together rather than with the slogan alone.

THE CONCEDED OBJECTION

- Rival paraphrases display different commitments, so the criterion presupposes a prior choice of theory and regimentation. Quine's position is that it audits a theory already chosen.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the criterion is applied after regimentation, it separates what a theory commits us to from which theory we ought to hold.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The bound-variable criterion audits the commitments of a regimented theory rather than counting its nouns, and it never chooses an ontology by itself.

STAGE 26 RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND THE FOUR-DOCTRINE TAXONOMY

- STIMULUS MEANING
- OBSERVATION SENTENCE
- ANALYTICAL HYPOTHESES
- APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION
- UNDETACHED RABBIT-PARTS
- INSCRUTABILITY: TERMS
- INDETERMINACY: MANUALS
- CHOMSKY 1969

THE EXACT TERMS

- Stimulus meaning pairs the class of stimulations prompting assent with the class prompting dissent; occasion sentences need fresh prompting while standing sentences do not; observation sentences have stimulus meaning constant across speakers.
- Analytical hypotheses are the linguist's posited segmentation of native sentences into words and grammatical apparatus, projected beyond the observational base and determined by no evidence.

THE PIVOT OF THE ARGUMENT

- 'Gavagai' fits rabbit, undetached rabbit-parts, a temporal stage of a rabbit, rabbithood and the feature-placing 'It's rabbiting'. The linguist cannot ask whether this gavagai is the same as that one, because the question needs the identity predicate, articles, plurals and quantifiers already translated.

FOUR DOCTRINES, FOUR UNITS

- Radical translation is a method; indeterminacy concerns rival manuals; inscrutability concerns sub-sentential terms; ontological relativity concerns frameworks. Chomsky presses the underdetermination collapse and Davidson confines indeterminacy to a choice of measurement scale.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because compensating adjustments preserve every behavioural prediction, nothing in observable use fixes reference uniquely and synonymy loses its anchor.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gavagai is the constructive half of the critique: Two Dogmas showed that analyticity could not be defined, and radical translation shows why, since there are no determinate meanings for a definition to capture.

STAGE 27 ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY AND NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY

- DEWEY LECTURES 1968
- VOLUME 1969
- REFERENCE RELATIVE TO A BACKGROUND THEORY
- ACQUIESCE IN THE MOTHER TONGUE
- NEURATH'S BOAT
- NORMATIVITY OBJECTION
- ENGINEERING REPLY

ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY

- Reference is settled only relative to a background theory or translation manual; specifying it requires another language whose reference is relative in turn, producing a regress.
- In practice we acquiesce in our mother tongue and take its reference at face value, which is a default and not a privilege. This is distinct from the 1948 criterion of commitment.

NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY

- Epistemology becomes a chapter of empirical science: the study of how meagre sensory input yields torrential theoretical output. The motive is the collapse of rational reconstruction.
- The governing image is Neurath's boat, the epigraph of Word and Object of 1960: we rebuild the ship on the open sea because there is no dry dock.

THE OBJECTION AND ITS RESIDUAL

- A causal account of belief-acquisition appears to replace the question of what one ought to believe. Quine replies that method-selection can be engineered from within science; the residual is that continuity with science does not by itself derive norms from causal facts.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because holism denies any standpoint outside the web, questions of reference and of justification must both be answered from inside a going theory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Naturalism is the consequence of holism rather than a separate enthusiasm: with no statement immune to revision, there is no vantage point from which philosophy could certify the web.

STAGE 28 STRAWSON: DESCRIPTIVE AGAINST REVISIONARY METAPHYSICS

- DESCRIBE THE ACTUAL STRUCTURE
- PROPOSE A BETTER STRUCTURE
- ARISTOTLE AND KANT
- DESCARTES, LEIBNIZ, BERKELEY
- CONNECTIVE ANALYSIS
- TRANSCENDENTAL IN FORM
- TWO DEFINITIONS WITH NO EXAMPLES IS FATAL

THE DISTINCTION AND ITS EXAMPLES

- Descriptive metaphysics describes the actual structure of our thought about the world; revisionary metaphysics proposes a better structure to replace it.
- Strawson's own descriptive allies are Aristotle and Kant; his revisionary contrasts are Descartes, Leibniz and Berkeley. Revisionary metaphysics is at its best in the service of the descriptive.

WHAT THE PROGRAMME COMMITS HIM TO

- Conclusions concern our conceptual scheme rather than mind-independent reality; the arguments are transcendental in form; and the method is connective analysis rather than reduction to a privileged base.
- An empiricist may accept the whole of Individuals as excellent conceptual geography while denying that it settles what exists, and conceding this strengthens an answer.

THE STANDING OBJECTION

- Descriptive metaphysics is charged with being circular or conservative because it protects the scheme used to state its own conditions. Strawson accepts an internal task: revision must begin within some functioning scheme.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the programme is descriptive by design, its modest reach is a stated commitment rather than a weakness to be conceded.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Strawson's metaphysics is descriptive by design, so its conclusions are about the structure of our conceptual scheme, and it is that modesty which makes his transcendental arguments work.

STAGE 29 BASIC PARTICULARS: THE FIVE-STEP ARGUMENT AND THE THREE DEFECTS

- IDENTIFICATION
- RE-IDENTIFICATION
- ONE SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK
- MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC
- SENSE-DATA ARE PRIVATE
- MOMENTARY
- NON-SPATIAL
- NOT ATOMS OR SIMPLES

THE ARGUMENT, IN FIVE STEPS

- To identify a particular we must distinguish it from others and re-identify it across time; re-identification requires a single unified spatio-temporal framework in which all particulars have locations.
- Material bodies are the enduring, publicly observable occupants of that framework and anchor demonstrative identification; the framework is a condition of our scheme and not a psychological image built out of bodies.
- Experiences, events and sounds are identified through their relations to persons, bodies, places and times, so material bodies are presupposed by the identification of everything else.

WHY THE EMPIRICIST CANDIDATE FAILS

- Sense-data are private and so cannot ground public identification, momentary and so cannot be re-identified, and non-spatial and so cannot constitute a framework at all. The failure is structural.
- Basic particulars are macroscopic bodies and persons, not microphysical atoms or simples.

SUPPORTING DOCTRINE

- Basic particulars are basic objects of reference, and feature-placing expressions such as 'It is raining here' do not replace the framework through which particular-reference becomes possible.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because each of the three defects independently disqualifies sense-data, the empiricist starting point fails as a matter of structure rather than of detail.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Material bodies are basic because identification requires re-identification, re-identification requires a single public spatio-temporal framework, and private momentary sense-data cannot constitute one.

STAGE 30 THE PURELY AUDITORY WORLD AND THE ANALOGUE OF SPACE

- ONLY PITCH AND SUCCESSION
- SAME PARTICULAR OR NEW ONE?
- ANALOGUE OF SPACE
- MASTER-SOUND
- NOT SIMPLY IMPOSSIBLE
- ANSWERS ANTHROPOCENTRISM

SET-UP AND PROBLEM

- A scheme containing only sounds - pitch, timbre, loudness and temporal succession - with no space and no bodies.
- Objective re-identification requires distinguishing the same particular encountered again from a new particular exactly resembling the first, and qualitative similarity alone cannot do this.

THE RESULT, STATED CAREFULLY

- Pitch and succession alone do not yet support robust objective re-identification, but the discussion does not simply prove an auditory scheme impossible.
- Objective reference would require an analogue of space, often reconstructed through a continuously available master-sound that organises sounds into a public-like framework.

WHAT IT SUPPORTS AND WHAT IT DOES NOT PROVE

- It supports the need for a framework performing the individuating role space performs in our scheme; it does not prove that every conceivable scheme must contain visual and tactile bodies exactly like ours.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the experiment isolates a functional role rather than a sensory modality, it answers the charge that descriptive metaphysics is merely parochial.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The auditory world does not show that a sound-only scheme is impossible; it shows what such a scheme would have to acquire, and thereby isolates the job that space does in ours.

STAGE 31 PERSONS: TWO PREDICATE-CLASSES ON ONE SUBJECT

- M-PREDICATES
- P-PREDICATES
- ONE SUBJECT
- OTHER-ASCRIBED ON PUBLIC CRITERIA
- SELF-ASCRIBED WITHOUT OBSERVATION
- LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE
- NOT A THIRD SUBSTANCE

THE PREDICATE MATRIX

- M-predicates are also applicable to mere bodies: weighs 70 kg, is in the kitchen, has brown hair. P-predicates ascribe states of consciousness: is in pain, is thinking of Vienna, believes it will rain, intends to leave.
- Both classes are ascribed to the same thing. A person is not a body to which a mind is attached, and 'the concept of a person is logically prior to that of an individual consciousness'.

THE ARGUMENT

- Self-ascription of P-predicates is possible only if the same predicates are ascribable to others; others are identified as embodied subjects on publicly available behavioural and situational criteria, not by inference to a hidden Cartesian mind.
- Yet the same predicates are self-ascribable without observation of one's own behaviour. A predicate with that dual character cannot be built from a pure consciousness or from a pure body, so its subject must already be both.

WHAT PRIMITIVE MEANS

- Conceptual priority within our scheme: not a third substance, not unanalysable in every respect, and not materialism, which loses the P-predicates altogether.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because a pure consciousness never reaches public criteria and a pure body never reaches unwitnessed self-ascription, only a subject that is already both satisfies the dual condition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Primitive here means conceptually prior, not mysterious: the concept of a person cannot be assembled out of the concepts of a mind and a body, because both are already parasitic on it.

STAGE 32 THE TWO RIVALS DESTROYED, AND THE ANSWER SPINE

- DUALISM: STARTING POINT UNDERCUT
- NO-OWNERSHIP: SELF-REFUTES
- THE EXPERIENCES HAD BY THIS BODY
- DISSOLVED, NOT SOLVED
- PRIMITIVE ENDS ANALYSIS
- DECIDE THE OWNER, DECODE THE DIRECTIVE
- CLOSE WITH A GRADED VERDICT

THE TWO RIVALS

- Cartesian dualism cannot identify or re-identify an immaterial soul in the single framework identification requires, and once the substances are separated their interaction becomes unintelligible.
- The no-ownership theory must say 'all the experiences that are had by this body' to state its own thesis, and 'had by' is possessive, so the personal framework returns inside the denial.

THE EXACT VERDICTS

- Dualism's starting point is undercut rather than simply outvoted; the no-ownership theory reconstructs the framework it tried to avoid; and the mind-body problem is dissolved because the decomposition generating it is illicit.
- The cost, conceded honestly, is that 'primitive' marks the end of analysis rather than an explanation of psychophysical unity.

THE ANSWER SPINE FOR EITHER THINKER

- Quine: dogma one, dogma two, holism with both quotations, Duhem-Quine with Neptune and Vulcan, the limits of 1970, and the verdict that empiricism is reformed rather than abandoned.
- Strawson: descriptive against revisionary, identification requiring re-identification requiring one framework, the three defects, persons with M- and P-predicates, both rivals refuted, and a scheme-relative verdict.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because both rivals help themselves to the unified subject they claim to dispense with, the person concept survives as the only position that can state what the others presuppose.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Strawson defeats Cartesianism more economically than any argument from interaction: he does not ask how mind and body interact but shows that the question presupposes a prior unity neither term can supply.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT - ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

- OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH
- INDETERMINACY OR UNDERDETERMINATION?
- IS DESCRIPTIVE METAPHYSICS CONSERVATIVE?
- IS PERSON REALLY PRIMITIVE?
- ONE MODULE AT 15, TWO AT 20
- NO MODULE IS PROMOTED TO CORE

INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

- Is indeterminacy of translation a distinct metaphysical thesis or ordinary underdetermination applied to semantics? Chomsky presses the collapse; Davidson accepts indeterminacy but confines it; a naturalistic reading treats translation and ontology as theory-relative anyway.
- Is descriptive metaphysics conservative common-sense mapping, a transcendental defence of the scheme within which all revision must begin, or a modest methodological programme?

SECOND-ORDER QUESTION ON PERSONS

- Must persons be conceptually basic, or can they be reduced to bodies plus psychological predicates, or to neo-Lockean continuity? The objection that 'primitive' is stipulative is answered by the dual ascription-condition that neither reduction can generate.

PROMOTION RECORD

- The 2 September 2026 semantic review left all three modules bounded: none is independently printed or PYQ-owned in 2018-2025, and none has been promoted to marks-essential core.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This enrichment stage is unnecessary for a competent core answer and is used only after the complete printed burden has been discharged.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels